

ODAWA NGALA

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SUMMARY

Entry-level cybersecurity professional with hands-on experience in security monitoring, incident triage, penetration testing, and vulnerability assessment. Skilled in using tools such as Burp Suite, Nmap, and Linux-based security environments to identify and mitigate system vulnerabilities. Practical exposure to SIEM concepts and log management through self-directed research and lab practice with tools including Wazuh, Splunk, and Syslog, alongside extensive hands-on labs on TryHackMe covering network reconnaissance, SQL injection, Windows security, Linux systems, and SIEM fundamentals. Experienced in log analysis, threat detection, and incident response in simulated enterprise environments, with a strong focus on identifying indicators of compromise and reducing organizational risk. Actively follows the evolving threat landscape through cybersecurity communities and sources such as CyberNews and security-focused discussion on X, with a commitment to continuous learning and strengthening organizational security posture.

PROJECTS, CYBERSECURITY & SYSTEMS TRAINING

- **SOC & SIEM Self-Directed Research** Researched and practiced core SOC analyst workflows, including SIEM-based log monitoring and alert triage, using Wazuh as an open-source SIEM/XDR platform to explore log collection, correlation rules, and alert generation. Studied Syslog as a standard logging protocol for centralizing and forwarding log data from endpoints and network devices into SIEM platforms. Explored Splunk's approach to log ingestion, search, and dashboarding to compare enterprise SIEM workflows.
- **Followed cybersecurity communities and sources** including CyberNews and security discussions to build awareness of current threats, vulnerabilities, and attack techniques.
- **Cybersecurity Boot Camp (WomenTechstars Fellowship)** Involved in intensive hands-on training in Linux systems administration, networking and security monitoring, strengthening end-to-end infrastructure management capabilities. Conducted practical labs in vulnerability scanning, penetration testing fundamentals and incident response, building a strong foundation in proactive and reactive security practices. Performed log analysis and threat detection in simulated enterprise environments, improving ability to identify and respond to potential security incidents. Configured firewalls and implemented IDS/IPS solutions in lab environments, enhancing network defense and intrusion detection capabilities. Executed server configuration and system hardening aligned with security best practices, reducing vulnerabilities and improving system resilience.
- **Practical Lab Platforms** Utilized practical lab platforms including TryHackMe, self-directed Linux administration labs and Hack The Box to build hands-on skills in systems administration, networking, log analysis and cybersecurity.

WORK EXPERIENCE

IoT & Systems Intern

Psalmchmart, Nairobi, Kenya 06/2023 - 09/2023

Supported the setup, configuration and maintenance of Linux-based systems and network-connected devices, improving system reliability and uptime. Contributed to cloud infrastructure configuration and monitoring, enhancing system performance and availability. Monitored server logs and network activity to proactively identify and resolve system and security issues, reducing downtime and risk exposure. Diagnosed and resolved hardware and system faults, improving operational efficiency and minimizing service disruptions. Installed and configured operating systems, drivers and network services, ensuring seamless system functionality and user readiness. Implemented basic network security controls including firewall configurations and access restrictions, strengthening system protection against unauthorized access. Assisted in vulnerability identification and applied security patches and updates, reducing exposure to potential threats and improving overall network security posture.

Trainer

CodeYetu, Nairobi, Kenya 10/2023 - Present Delivered hands-on training in foundational technology and coding skills, enabling students to build practical projects and apply concepts in real-world scenarios. Guided learners in developing problem-solving and logical thinking abilities, improving their analytical skills and approach to complex tasks. Facilitated collaborative learning environments, encouraging teamwork, peer learning and effective communication among students. Introduced students to industry tools including Git and modern development frameworks, enhancing their technical proficiency and readiness for real-world applications. Mentored and supported students throughout project development, building confidence, creativity and a strong foundation in technology.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Bioprocessing Engineering

Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology (JKUAT)

CERTIFICATIONS

Women Techsters Fellowship Program (Cybersecurity Track) - Ongoing ISOC - Designing and Deploying Computer Networks Introduction to Cybersecurity Essentials - CISCO TryHackMe Cyber Security Learning Paths Ethical Hacker - CISCO Cyber Threat Management - CISCO Introduction to AI - HP

SKILLS

Security Monitoring & Incident Response: SIEM Concepts and Log Analysis (Wazuh, Splunk, Syslog), Security Alert Triage and Validation, Incident Investigation and Documentation, Indicators of Compromise (IOC) Identification, Endpoint and Network Log Analysis, Incident Response Fundamentals, Tabletop Exercise Participation (Lab) IT Infrastructure & Systems Administration: Linux and UNIX Administration, Windows Server (Basic Administration), Server Setup and Configuration, Local and Cloud Infrastructure Maintenance, Virtualization (VirtualBox/VMware), VPN Setup and Administration, Email Server Concepts, System Monitoring and Performance Optimization Networking and Cloud: Network Troubleshooting, TCP/IP Fundamentals, Firewall Configuration (Lab), IDS/IPS (Lab), AWS (IAM, EC2 Concepts), Azure Fundamentals, Cloud-Based System Integration Cybersecurity and Vulnerability Management: Vulnerability Scanning, Server Hardening and Security Best Practices, Risk Awareness, Data Backup and Restoration, Business Continuity Support, Security Awareness and Phishing Simulation Concepts Hardware and Technical Support: Hardware Diagnostics and Repairs, Installation and Replacement of Components, Peripheral Configuration, Remote and Onsite Technical Support Tools: Wazuh (SIEM), Splunk (SIEM), Syslog, Linux (Kali, Ubuntu), Nmap, Wireshark, Burp Suite, Git and GitHub, OpenVPN